

Confidential Internal Investigation Report

Pinnacle Financial Partners • August 2026

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL: INTERNAL INVESTIGATION REPORT

Case Reference: ER-2026-084

Investigator: Sarah Jenkins, Senior Employee Relations Business Partner

Date Opened: August 3, 2026

Date Concluded: August 18, 2026

Allegation Summary:

On August 3, 2026, HR received a formal written complaint from a Junior Financial Analyst (the "Complainant") alleging that the Director of Regional Operations (the "Respondent") created a hostile work environment. Specifically, the Complainant alleged that the Respondent frequently used aggressive language, made unreasonable after-hours demands, and publicly berated team members during weekly pipeline reviews.

Investigation Process:

Over a two-week period, Employee Relations conducted formal, documented interviews with the Complainant, the Respondent, and four designated witnesses (peer-level analysts and an administrative assistant). Additionally, HR reviewed six months of internal Slack communications and email threads between the involved parties.

Findings of Fact:

- The investigation did not find evidence of discriminatory language or actions violating the company's Title VII Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) policies.
- Witness testimonies corroborated the Complainant's assertion that the Respondent routinely raised his voice during pipeline reviews and exhibited a harsh management style.
- Digital forensics revealed that the Respondent sent an average of 4.5 messages per week between 10:00 PM and 1:00 AM, with expectations of immediate replies, contrary to the firm's "Right to Disconnect" policy.

Conclusion and Recommendations:

While the Respondent's behavior does not legally constitute a "hostile work environment" based on a protected class, it significantly violates Pinnacle Financial Partners' Professional Code of Conduct and leadership expectations.

Recommended Disciplinary Action:

- Issue a Final Written Warning to the Respondent regarding workplace professionalism and communication standards.
- Mandate the Respondent's enrollment in a 12-week Executive Coaching and Anger Management program.

- Implement a 90-day transfer of direct reporting lines; the Complainant will temporarily report to the VP of Finance while the Respondent completes the mandated coaching.